Console on the Move

How to drive the Console app on an Ableton Move: an 8-track tape with OP-1-style editing, up to 8 instruments (drum machines and synths) and a step sequencer. This covers the controls as they are in November 2026. Things still to come are listed at the end.

Starting and stopping

Start Console	Shift + Step 2 (the Move's settings), then choose **RNBO** at the bottom of the list. Console opens by itself after a few seconds. The menu item keeps the name RNBO.
Quit	**Shift + Back**. Saves the song, quits and gives the Move back to its normal software.
If something goes wrong	If the app ever crashes, the Move goes back to normal by itself. What it printed is saved in /data/UserData/console/app.log.
Update	On the Move: Menu, SETTINGS, SOFTWARE UPDATE (push to check, push again to install; Console restarts). Or from the Mac: `ssh ableton@move.local "python3 /data/UserData/console/move/move-update.py"`.

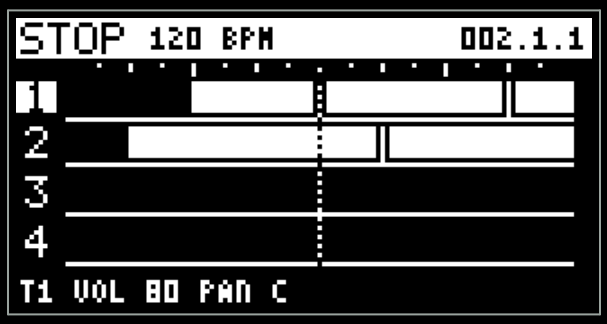
The Move's controls at a glance

Most buttons have a second job with **Shift** held. Each page below says what changes there.

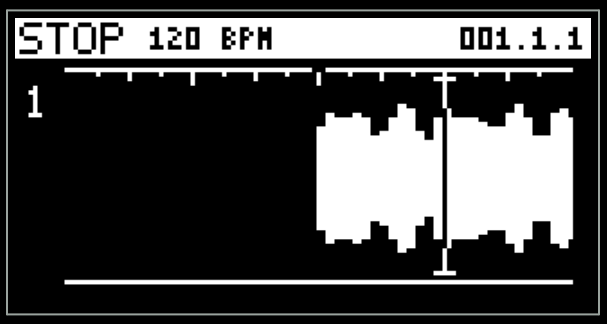
Play	Play / stop. Shift: back to the start (or the loop's start).
Record	Record on the selected track (and any armed tracks). Shift: switch between replacing the tape and adding to it (overdub).
Loop	Loop between the in and out points on / off. Shift: clear the in and out points.
Left / Right arrows	Move the playhead one grid step. Shift: set the loop's in / out point at the playhead.
Undo	Undo the last tape edit (on the drum sequencer: the last pattern edit).
Sample	Splice: split the box under the playhead (at a splice: join it back). Shift: on every track.
Copy (hold)	Copy the box under the playhead. Hold and turn the jog wheel to take more pieces, let go to copy. Shift + Copy: start a selection.
Delete (hold)	Cut, the same way as Copy (it leaves an empty space).
Capture	Drop (paste) what was copied or cut at the playhead. Shift: insert it, pushing the rest of the track later.
Mute	Mute the selected track. Shift: solo it.
Menu	The project menu (songs, tempo, settings). On the drum page: the kit menu. **Shift + Menu: export.**

Back	Back out of a menu or page. **Shift + Back: save and quit.**
Left buttons (top to bottom)	1 Instruments (press again: the instrument's sound, again: its sequencer; Shift: back). 2 Song mode. 3 FX (reverb, delay, the insert effect if you installed one, then off). 4 The recorder (the tape; press again: the selected track zoomed. Shift: arm all tracks).
Knobs 1-8	Depend on the page (below). On the tape: the 8 tracks' volumes; Shift: pan.
Shift + touch a knob	Pushes that knob (the Pi's knob push): on the tape it mutes that track.
+ / -	The Pi's knob 9: on the tape, zoom in / out. Shift: sweep the in / out points a bar at a time.
Jog wheel	Turn: move the playhead a grid step. Shift + turn: the grid size. Push: back to the start. In lists and menus: turn to pick, push to choose.
Volume knob	Headphone / speaker volume.
Step buttons	On the tape: 1-8 select a track (press the selected one again to zoom in); Shift + step: arm a track. On the drum sequencer: the 16 steps.
Pads	Drums: the left 4 x 4 are the drums (bottom left first; tapping one picks it), the right 4 x 4 play the picked drum chromatically, a semitone a pad (bright pads: the root). A synth plays a scale. **Shift + pad 1-16: the instrument's pattern.**

The tape



The tape page: four tracks at a time (the selected track's group) as solid boxes; a splice is a thin divider. The dotted line is the playhead. Bottom: volume and pan.



Left button 4 again: the selected track zoomed, its sound as a waveform; a splice is an I-beam. The notch in the ruler is the playhead.

Step buttons 1-8	Select a track (its light is white). Selecting doesn't arm it.
Shift + step 1-8	Arm or disarm a track: **armed tracks are red** (selected and armed: red and white blinking) and have a bar beside the number on the screen. **Record only records armed tracks** (arm every track you want: say a drum and a synth together). Armed tracks' instruments sound on the tape page, and Copy / Delete / Sample take them along.
Knobs 1-8	Track volumes. Shift + knob: pan.
Record	Start / stop recording on the selected track and any armed tracks.
Splices	A splice shows as a thin divider between two boxes (zoomed in: an I-beam through the sound).

The zoomed track (left button 4, twice)

Knob 1	Mono / stereo (about 5 clicks to switch).
Knob 2	The input: an instrument's drum, its kit, all kits (and on a stereo track, its left side). About 5 clicks per choice.
Knob 3	A stereo track's right input.
Knobs 4-6	The box under the playhead: gain, fade in, fade out. Shift + touch knob 4: normalize.
Left button 4 / Back	Back to the tape.

Instruments

Left button 1 opens the INSTRUMENTS page: 8 slots, each a drum machine or a synth. Recording an instrument onto the tape uses the zoomed track's input (knob 2).

Jog wheel	Pick a slot. Push: open it (an empty slot: choose what goes in it).
Choosing an instrument	A picture of each instrument scrolls left and right as you turn the wheel (the ones without a picture yet show their name). Push to choose. The last choice, **+ GET MORE FROM SCHWUNG**, is a store of ready-made Schwung instruments and effects: push to install one (the Move needs Wi-Fi; it downloads straight from GitHub).
SAMPLER	A drum machine of 16 samples, one per drum: each takes a .wav from the Move's sample folders (SAMPLE, LEVEL, PITCH, START, DECAY, PAN, REVERB, DELAY).
Shift + push the jog wheel	On a loaded slot: change it or remove it.
Step buttons 1-8	Mute / unmute a slot.
Left button 1 again	The picked instrument's sound page; again: its sequencer.

Recording the Move's input jack

The zoomed track's input (knob 2) also offers **INPUT L** and **INPUT R**: whatever is plugged into the Move's audio input (a guitar, a mic). Pick one for a mono track, both for stereo. You hear it while you arm the track.

An instrument's sound

Knobs 1-8	The settings on this page. While one turns, it shows big.
Up / Down (+ / -)	The pads' octave (a synth's pads, and the chromatic drum pads on the right). The screen shows OCT +1 etc.
Left / Right	The previous / next page of settings.
Shift + touch a knob	That setting back to its starting value.
Settings that pick a mode	DIST, CHOKE, a wave, on / off: it takes 5 clicks the same way to move to the next choice, so you don't skip past. Shift + turn: one choice a click. Lists get 3 clicks a choice: the lane's RATE, MULTIPLY / PULSE / HOLD / JUMP and the pitch ones, song-mode patterns, the grid and the pattern (Shift + wheel). Numbers (volume, velocity, tune...) take 3 clicks a step.
Knob speed	Shift + turn the volume knob: how many clicks of a knob make one step of a number (1-12, starts at 4). More clicks = easier to be precise. It is kept when you switch off.
Reverb and delay	Each drum's REVERB and DELAY knobs on its sound page set how much of that drum goes to the effect. The effects' own settings (size, time, tone, feedback, level) are on left button 3.
Pads	Play the drums (or the synth).
Menu	The kit menu (load / save kits).

LFOs

Every instrument has two LFOs per pattern (a new pattern starts as a copy of the one you came from, then they are separate). On a sound page press **Right** past the last page: LFO 1, again: LFO 2.

Knob 1 DEST	Which setting it moves (numbers only).
Knob 2 WAVE	Sine, triangle, saw up / down, square, random.
Knob 3 SPEED	8 bars down to 1/32 of a beat, in time with the tempo.
Knob 4 DEPTH	How far it swings, -100 to +100 %.
Knob 5 PHASE	Where in the cycle it starts.
Knob 6 MODE	FREE (runs with the song) or TRIG (restarts at the pattern's first step).
Step buttons	The LFO's 16 steps (1/16 notes, one bar). Tap: that step rests. Hold a step and turn knob 2 (its own WAVE) or knob 4 (its own DEPTH).

The drum sequencer

The steps live on the 16 step buttons, the screen shows what the knobs do. Each drum (lane) has its own length, up to 64 steps, and its own speed.

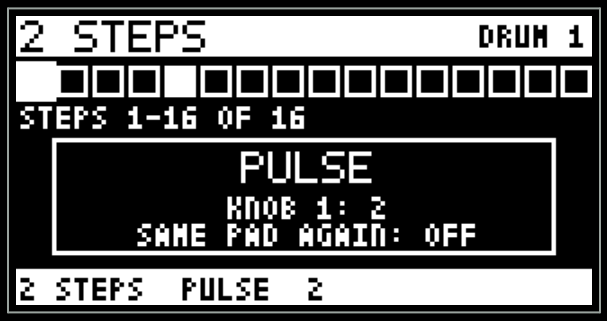
The drum's 16 steps (small, at the top) and the lane's settings.

Shift + steps 1 and 5 tapped: they blink, and the pads are their settings.

Pads	Left 4 x 4: pick the drum (its pad lights brighter) and hear it. Shift + pad: the pattern.
Step buttons	Tap: the step on / off. While playing, the playhead moves along them.
Shift + step buttons	Select steps to set (below).
Left / Right arrows	Steps 17-32, 33-48, 49-64 (for lanes longer than 16).
Knob 1	LENGTH: the lane's number of steps (1-64).
Knob 2	RATE: the lane's speed (1/16, 1/16 triplets, 1/8, 1/8 triplets, 1/32).
Knob 3	EUCLID: spread a number of hits evenly over the lane (OFF to switch it off).
Knob 4	SHIFT: turn the lane's pattern around by steps.
+ / -	The pattern (1-16). While playing, the next one waits its turn (shown as PAT 1>2).
Undo	Undo the last pattern edit.

Step settings (OP-XY style)

Hold Shift and tap one or more steps: they blink. Let go of Shift. Now the pads are the steps' settings, bottom left first. Tap a pad: that setting is on and **knob 1** sets it. Tap the same pad again: it's off (back to normal). Lit pads: settings the step has; the picked one blinks. **Tap any step to finish.**



PULSE picked on two steps: knob 1 sets how many times they repeat.

Pad 1 VELOCITY	How hard (1-127, turned all the way down: RND, random).
Pad 2 CHANCE	How often it plays: 100% down to 0%, or 1:2, 2:3... (the 1st of every 2 times round, and so on).
Pad 3 MULTIPLY	Hits inside the step: x1 to x8, or RND.
Pad 4 PULSE	Play the step again 1-9 times (or RND) before moving on.
Pad 5 HOLD	Wait 1-9 steps (or RND) after it, silent.
Pad 6 JUMP	Then go to step 1, 5, 9 or 13, skip one (+1), back one (-1), either (+/-), or RND. Once each time round the lane.
Pad 7 RANDOM	A random pitch each time: 2-6 notes over 1 or 3 octaves.
Pad 8 RAMP UP	The pitch goes up each time round: 2-6 notes over 1 or 3 octaves.
Pad 9 RAMP DOWN	The same, going down. (One of RANDOM / RAMP UP / RAMP DOWN at a time.)
Pads 10-32	The drum's own sound settings (TUNE, DECAY...): a parameter lock for these steps.

Pitch moves use the drum's TUNE (or PITCH) setting, so how far a semitone goes depends on the drum machine. BEND, PORTAMENTO and TONALITY are for the synth sequencer, still to come.

Song mode (left button 2)

A list of rows, OP-XY style: each row picks a pattern for every instrument and says how many times it plays. With song mode on, Play starts at row 1 and goes through the rows, then round again.

Row 2: the LXR plays pattern 3, twice.

Step buttons	The rows. Press one past the end: a new row (a copy of the last). Lit: the rows; the playing one blinks.
Delete + step button	Take that row out.
Knobs 1-7	The row's pattern for instruments 1-7 (all the way down: -, leave it as it is).
Knob 8	How many times the row plays (1-16).
+ / -	+ switches song mode on, - off. **Shift + left button 2** does the same from any page (the tape shows SONG in its top line while it's on). Off: the picked pattern plays, as usual.

The synth sequencer

A synth's sequencer works on chords. The 16 step buttons are the steps (Left / Right for more).

Step buttons	Tap: the notes on / off. Hold a step: the pads light its notes; tap pads to add or remove notes. Hold a step and tap a later step: that is where the notes end (also across pages).
Knobs (no step held)	1 length, 2 rate, 3 type (UNIFIED: one sequence; PER NOTE: tap a pad to see only its steps), 4 the lit note's own length, 5 key, 6 scale.
Shift + steps	Select steps: the pads are their settings. LENGTH, VELOCITY, CHANCE, MULTIPLY, **NUDGE** (a step early or late, -50 to +50 %), then the synth's own settings as parameter locks. Knob 1 sets the picked one.
Record	On a drum or synth sequencer page: the pads you play go into the pattern while it plays (a synth note lasts as long as you hold the pad; chromatic drum pads keep their pitch). Press again to stop. It doesn't touch the tape.
Drums, by hand	Hold a step button and press a right-half pad: the step turns on with that pitch.

FX

The reverb and delay are on each instrument *before* the tape, so they are recorded with the sound.

Left button 3	Reverb page, again: delay page, again: the INSERT page (only once you have installed an effect), again: back.
Knobs 1-3	The effect: reverb size, tone, level / delay time, feedback, level.
Knob 4	How much of the picked instrument goes to this effect.
INSERT page	Knob 1 picks an installed Schwung effect (Tapescam, Ducker...), knobs 2-4 its first three settings. It sits on the whole output, so it is not recorded on the tape. The Ducker ducks when drum 1 is hit.

Ableton Link

Menu, SETTINGS, MIDI SYNC, LINK. Console then shares its tempo (while stopped; a playing tape keeps its tempo) and its Play / Stop with Live and phone apps on the same Wi-Fi. Starting waits for the next bar.

Menus and export

Menu	The project menu: songs (new, open, save as), tempo, time signature, export format, settings. Jog wheel: pick, push: choose, Back: close.
Shift + Menu	Export: a stereo mix and one file per track, in /data/UserData/console/data/exports/(song name and time)/.

To copy the exports to the Mac's desktop:

```
scp -r "ableton@move.local:/data/UserData/console/data/exports" ~/Desktop/move-exports
```

Not on the Move yet

Step components (pulse, hold, jump) on synth notes; the LFOs' parameter locks beyond depth and wave; pictures for the instruments that still show their name; the tape's bar/beat grid when zoomed in a long way. Songs are saved in /data/UserData/console/data.